V-L-61G
January 11, 1979
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. V-L-61F
November 24, 1970

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

LACES, NYLON

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of nylon laces.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Laces shall be of two types in the following classes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Spun nylon laces.

Class 1 - 7/32 inch (6 mm) width, flat.
Class 2 - 10/32 inch (8 mm) width, flat.

Type II - Bulked filament nylon laces.

Class 1 - 3/32 inch (2 mm) diameter, round.
Class 2 - 8/32 inch (6 mm) width, flat
Class 3 - 4/32 inch (3 mm) diameter, round.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing.

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
FED-STD-191	-	Textile Test Methods.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-1188	-	Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. This specification contains provisions for first article inspection and approval (see 4.2, 6.2 and 6.4).

3.3 Material (see 6.5).

3.3.1 Nylon yarn. The nylon yarn for braiding type I, classes 1 and 2 laces shall be spun from nylon staple and twisted into a 2-ply yarn. The nylon yarn for braiding type II, classes 1 and 2 laces, shall be a 210 denier (23 tex) continuous multifilament yarn which has been increased in size to 230-250 denier (26-28 tex) by air bulking. The cover yarns and warp yarns for braiding type II, class 3 laces shall be made from 840 denier (93 tex) high tenacity continuous multifilament nylon yarn which has been increased to 940-1000 denier (104-111 tex) by the air bulking process; and the stuffer shall be one end of 10,080 denier (1120 tex) high tenacity continuous multifilament nylon yarn, which is not air bulked. The stuffer shall not be braided.

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3.3.2 Tips. The tips shall be made from nylon sheet or film having a thickness of .013 to .016 inch (0.330 to 0.406 mm). The color of the tips shall be black for black laces and clear for all other colored laces. As an alternate method, the ends of type II, class 1 and 3 laces shall be self-tipped by heat molding.

3.4 Color. The color of the finished laces shall be as specified (see 6.2) except the stuffer yarn for type II, class 3 lace need not be dyed.

3.4.1 Color matching. The color shall match the standard sample (when available) under artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2800 kelvin.

3.4.2 Colorfastness. The dyed laces shall show colorfastness to water equal to, or better than, the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2. When no standard sample is available, the dyed laces shall show "good" colorfastness to water when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.5 Braid. The braid for the laces shall be tubular braided without a core except for type II, class 3 which has a stuffer core. All laces shall use a two over and two under braiding except type II, class 2 which shall braid one pair over and one pair under. The braid shall be pressed flat for type I, classes 1 and 2, and for type II, class 2 laces in accordance with commercial practice. The braid for the laces shall conform to the physical requirements in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Type	Class	Width Tol.± 1/32 (0.8) inch(mm)	Carriers minimum	Ends per carrier minimum	Warp ends minimum	Stuffer minimum	Picks per inch (/mm) minimum	Breaking strength lbs (N) minimum
I	1	7/32(6)	44	1	-	-	38(15)	95(423)
I	2	10/32(8)	44	2	-	-	26(10)	175(778)
II	1	3/32(2) (diam.)	16	3	-	-	28(11)	100(445)
II	2	8/32(6)	44 1/	2	-	-	17(7)	190(845)
II	3	4/32(3) (diam.)	8	2	4	1	16(6)	180(801)

1/ Carriers braiding in pairs.

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3.6 Tipping. Both ends of the braid shall be provided with a firmly attached and secured tip made from the material specified in 3.3.2. The alternate method of tipping shall be as indicated in 3.3.2. Tips shall be 3/4 ± 1/16 inch (19 ± 2 mm) long.

3.6.1 Gripping strength. The nylon tips made from nylon sheet or film shall have a minimum gripping strength of 25 pounds (111 N) for classes 1 and 3 laces and 40 pounds (178 N) for class 2 laces when subjected to the test specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.6.2 Compression strength. The tips made from nylon sheeting or film shall not crack, dislodge from their position, or peel from the lace when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.7 Length. Laces shall be furnished in lengths, including tips, as specified (see 6.2). The laces shall be cut so as to insure the specified length when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2. Laces under 40 inches (1016 mm) shall have a length tolerance of plus 5 percent, and laces 40 inches (1016 mm) and longer shall have a length tolerance of plus 3 percent.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished laces shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. Occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When required (see 6.2), the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.1.1 and 4.4.2.1.2 for compliance with material, construction, workmanship and dimensional requirements. The sample shall be tested for physical and chemical characteristics in accordance with 4.4.2.2.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents. In addition, testing shall be performed on components listed in table II for the characteristics shown. The inspection level for each component shall be level S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) for each component shall be 6.5 test failures per hundred units. All requirements are applicable to the sample unit. When the data in the "Number of determinations per sample unit" and "Results reported as" colums are not specified in table II, they shall be as required by the referenced test method.

TABLE II. Component tests

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement para.	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Nylon sheet (10 sheets)	Thickness	3.3.2	Gauge	3	Average of 3 determinations to the nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm)	6 by 1-1/2 inches (152 by 38 mm) or equivalent
	Material identification	3.3.2	3/	-	-	-
Nylon yarn, type II, before and after air bulking (1 cone, tube or spool of each)	Filament	3.3.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail	1 cone spool or tube of each
	Denier 1/ 2/	3.3.1	4021 of FED-STD-191	-	-	-

1/ The contractor shall certify that a 210 denier (23 tex) filament yarn was used prior to air bulking for type II, classes 1 and 2 laces.

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2/ The contractor shall certify that an 840 denier (93 tex) filament yarn was used prior to air bulking for type II, class 3.

3/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.

4.4.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.4.2.1 Examination of the end item. The laces shall be examined for defects in workmanship and material, and for overall length of tips. Defects found during these examinations shall be classified in accordance with 4.4.2.1.1 and 4.4.2.1.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one completely finished lace. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one lace each.

4.4.2.1.1 Visual examination. The inspection level for this examination shall be level I and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Laces	Any broken yarn. Frayed. Rub or abrasion marks. Hole, cut, or tear. Unevenly braided resulting in open place or break in continuity of braid. Pulled yarn or uneven tension resulting in uneven width. Other than tubular braided with a core, when applicable. Other than tubular braided without a core, when applicable. Flat lace, when applicable, not flat for a distance of 2 inches (51 mm) or more. Round lace, when applicable, not round for a distance of 2 inches (51 mm) or more. Slub, knot, or abruptly thickened place which may affect utility. Color other than specified. Offshade. Spot, stain, or other discoloration affecting appearance. Objectionable odor.

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Examine	Defect
Tipping	Any tip missing, damaged, malformed, or insecurely attached. Inadequate heat molding, e.g., burned, brittle, incomplete, sharp edges (for type II, classes 1 and 3 only). Tipping of braid not neatly accomplished. Self-tipped by heat molding on other than type II, classes 1 and 3. Not fabricated of nylon sheet, when applicable. Color - clear or any color other than black for black laces. Color - any color other than clear for laces other than black. End of tip projects beyond the braid more than 1/16 inch (2 mm) (for attached tips only). End of braid projects beyond the tip end more than 1/16 inch (2 mm) (for attached tips only). Thickness, width, or diameter of tip greater than thickness, width, or diameter of braid.

4.4.2.1.2 Examination for overall length of tip ends. Any overall length of tip exceeding specified tolerances specified in 3.6 shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level for this examination shall be S-3 and the AQL shall be 1.0 defect per hundred units.

4.4.2.2 Testing of the end item. Testing of the completely fabricated laces shall be performed in accordance with table III and FED-STD-191 for characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 test failures per hundred units. The sample unit for tests shall be 20 completely fabricated laces, except when type II, class 1 or 3 laces are purchased and they have been self-tipped by heat molding, the sample unit shall be 15 laces. Requirements are applicable to the sample unit. When the data in the "Number of determinations per sample unit" and "Results reported as" columns are not specified in table III, they shall be as required by the referenced test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one lace each.

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TABLE III. End item tests

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Nylon identification 1/	3.3.1	1530	-	-
Yarn ply (type I)	3.3.1	Visual	1	Number of plies
Staple (type I)	3.3.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Bulked multifilament (type II)	3.3.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Colorfastness to water	3.4.2	5630	-	-
Braiding type	3.5	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Width or diameter	Table I	4.5.1	3	Average to nearest 1/32 inch (1 mm)
Carriers	Table I	Visual	1	Number of carriers
Ends per carrier	Table I	Visual	1	Number of ends
Warp ends (type II, class 3)	Table I	Visual	1	Number of warp ends
Stuffer (type II, class 3)	Table I	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Picks per inch	Table I	Visual	1	Number of picks
Breaking strength	Table I	4102 and 4.5.3	-	-
Gripping strength (tips)	3.6.1	4.5.5	10	Average to nearest 1 lb. (1 N)
Compression strength (tips)	3.6.2	4.5.4	1	Pass or fail

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TABLE III. End item tests (cont'd)

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Length, overall	3.7	4.5.2	1	To the nearest 1/16 inch (1 mm)

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirements.

4.4.3 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing, and marking comply with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packaged with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination for closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and unit pack)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, improper taping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of unit packs per container is more or less than required. Number of laces per unit pack is more or less than required. 1/

1/ One unit pack from each shipping container in the sample shall be examined.

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4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Width or diameter. The width or diameter shall be determined at three points at least 9 inches (229 mm) apart by steel rule graduated in thirty-seconds of an inch, or by a caliper-type gauge and the results averaged. The measurements shall be taken with the test lace suspended vertically under a load of 3 ounces (.8 N) for class 1, and 6 ounces (1.7 N) for class 2 and 3 laces.

4.5.2 Length. The finished lace shall not be stretched or tensioned prior to the length test. The finished lace shall be suspended vertically under a load of 3 ounces (.8 N) for class 1 and 3, and 6 ounces (1.7 N) for class 2, and then measured from end to end including tips.

4.5.3 Breaking strength. The breaking strength of the laces shall be determined as specified in Method 4102 of FED-STD-191 except that the clamps shall be not less than 2 inches (51 mm) in diameter and the distance between the center of the clamps at the start of the test shall be 6 inches ± 1/16 inch (152 ± 2 mm). When the lace length is less than 24 inches (610 mm), a flat-type jaw shall be used in lieu of a drum-type jaw.

4.5.4 Compression strength. The tip shall be placed between flat blocks of steel and subjected to a gradually applied crushing load of 1000 pounds (450 kg).

4.5.5 Gripping strength of tips.

4.5.5.1 Test specimen. The specimen shall be a one-half length of a shoe lace. (Two determinations may be made from one complete shoe lace.)

4.5.5.2 Apparatus.

4.5.5.2.1 Testing machine. The testing machine shall be as described in Method 5100 of FED-STD-191 except a slotted metal plate as shown in figure 1 shall be used in connection with the top jaw assembly and the distance between the upper jaw (slotted metal plate) and the lower jaw or clamp shall be 4 inches ± 1/16 inch (102 ± 2 mm). The lower jaw shall be as described in Method 5100 or 4102 of FED-STD-191.

4.5.5.2.2 Metal plate (figure 1). The rigid metal plate shall be of the approximate dimensions 5 inches (127 mm) long by 1-1/2 inches (38 mm) wide and shall contain a 4 inch (102 mm) tapered slot centered widthwise and running lengthwise from an inside dimension of 1/32 inch (1 mm) in width, increasing to a width of 1/4 inch (6 mm) at the outside edge. The slot shall be smoothly finished. It is not required that the plate be of a single piece of metal. The slot may be formed by a clamped or bolted assembly of two metal bars or plates properly spaced apart. The plate shall be supported in a horizontal position in, or on, top jaw of the apparatus.

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4.5.5.3 Procedure. The lace shall be passed upward, tip first, through the jaw assembly and through the wide end of the slot until the tip clears the plate, and then moved horizontally toward the narrow end of the slot until the end of the tip rests on top of the metal plate. The free end of the specimen (lace) shall be fastened in the lower jaw or clamp. The machine shall be started, with the pawl in contact with the ratchet, and the maximum resistance in displacing the tip shall be recorded. The force shall be applied to the specimen at such a rate that the pulling clamp will travel at a uniform speed of 12 inches ± 0.5 inch (305 ± 13 mm) per minute. After the tip has been forced from the lace, the resultant force shall be read from the dial, scale, or chart and the value recorded to the nearest pound. If the lace tip slips through the slot without its being removed from the lace or if, for any reason attributed to faulty technique, an individual measurement falls markedly below the average test for the sample unit, such result shall be discarded and another specimen shall be tested. Buckling of the tip material at the base of the tip without the tip being removed from the lace shall not be considered as a failure of the tip.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Five gross of laces of one type, class, length, and color only shall be unit packed in a compact bundle having approximate overall dimensions as specified in table IV. Prior to bundling, the laces shall be grouped full length in one-gross lots and securely tied together. Each unit pack of laces shall be completely wrapped in 60 pound minimum basis weight (98 g/m^2) kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be securely sealed with 2 inch (51 mm) minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45.

5.1.2 Commercial. Laces shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Laces of one type, class, length, and color only, preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed in the quantities and arrangement as specified in table IV. Approximate inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be as specified in table IV. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.3.

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5.2.2 Level B packing. Laces of one type, class, length, and color only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or type SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed in the quantities and arrangement as specified in table IV. Approximate inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be as specified in table IV. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.3.

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TABLE IV. Packing details

Bundle 1/			Arrangement in container				Shipping container 1/ Inside dimensions (inches) 2/		
Class	Length, inches 2/	Overall dimensions, inches 2/	Number of unit packs per cont.	Length	Width	Depth	Length	Width	Depth
1	21	10-1/2 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	16	2	2	4	21	15	14-1/4
1	25	12-1/2 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	16	2	2	4	27	15	14-1/4
1	27	13-1/2 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	16	2	2	4	27	15	14-1/4
1	28-1/2	14-1/2 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	16	2	2	4	30	15	14-1/4
1	30	15 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	16	2	2	4	30	15	14-1/4
1	40	10 by 15 by 3-1/2	16	2	2	4	30	20	14-1/4
1	50	25 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	8	1	2	4	27	15	14-1/4
1	52	26 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	8	1	2	4	27	15	14-1/4
1	54	27 by 7-1/2 by 3-1/2	8	1	2	4	27	15	14-1/4
1	60	30 by 7-1/2 by 7	4	1	2	2	30	15	14-1/4
1	84	21 by 15 by 3-1/2	8	2	1	4	30	21	14-1/4
2	30	15 by 7-1/2 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	15	14-1/4
2	40	10 by 15 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	20	14-1/4
2	44	11 by 15 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	22	14-1/4
2	52	26 by 7-1/2 by 7	4	1	2	2	27	15	14-1/4
2	60	30 by 7-1/2 by 7	4	1	2	2	30	15	14-1/4
2	64	16 by 15 by 7	4	2	1	2	30	16	14-1/4
3	60	30 by 7-1/2 by 7	4	1	2	2	30	15	14-1/4

1/ Bundle and container dimensions are approximations and are furnished as a guide only.

2/ Metric equivalent for inches expressed in millimeters are as follows:

Inches	Millimeters	Inches	Millimeters	Inches	Millimeters
3-1/2	89	14-1/2	368	28-1/2	724
7	178	15	381	30	762
7-1/2	191	16	406	40	1016
10	254	20	508	44	1118
10-1/2	267	21	533	50	1270
11	279	22	559	52	1321
12-1/2	317	25	635	54	1372
13-1/2	343	26	660	60	1524
14-1/4	362	27	686	64	1626
				84	2134

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5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in PPP-B-636, except inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.3.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Laces, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, unit packs and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, unit packs and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The nylon laces are intended for use with various types of footwear, clothing and equipage.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, and length required (see 1.2 and 3.7).
(c) First article (see 3.2, 4.2 and 6.4).
(d) Color required (see 3.4).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(g) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Sample. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

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6.4 First article. The item covered by this specification requires first article inspection and approval under the appropriate provisions of paragraph 7-104.55 of the Armed Services Procurement Regulations. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of twenty finished laces. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments, regarding arrangements for examination, test and approval of first article.

6.5 Recycled materials. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification (see 3.3).

6.6 Metric equivalents. Metric equivalents, indicated in parentheses throughout this document, are based on practices, conversion factors, and symbols specified in ASTM E 380 Standard for Metric Practice, and are for information only. In each instance, the value stated in US customary units shall be controlling.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 45
DLA - CT

User activity:

Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordination Activity-

GSA-FSS

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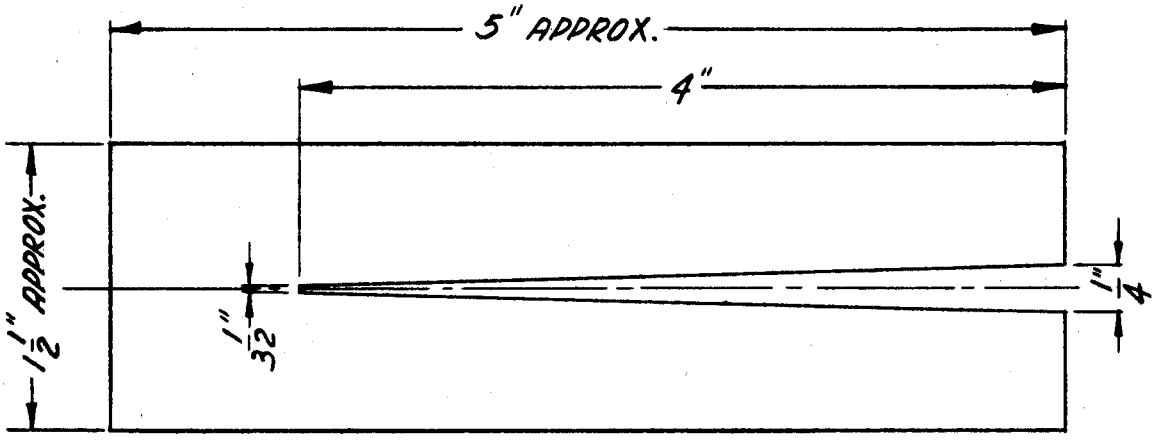


FIGURE 1 SLOTTED METAL PLATE

2-1-409

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